

AWS Interview – Real & Professional Answers

These answers are written for interviews (0–3 years experience). Language is simple, practical, and suitable to speak during an interview.

Q: What is Amazon EC2?

A: EC2 is a service that provides virtual servers in the cloud. It allows us to launch servers on demand, choose CPU, memory, and OS, and pay only for what we use. Companies use EC2 to host applications, APIs, and backend services.

Q: What is Amazon S3?

A: S3 is an object storage service used to store files like images, videos, backups, and logs. It is highly durable and scalable. A common use case is storing application data or static website content.

Q: Difference between EC2 and S3?

A: EC2 is compute used to run applications, while S3 is storage used to store data. EC2 runs code; S3 stores files.

Q: What is an AMI?

A: An AMI is a template used to launch EC2 instances. It contains OS, software, and configurations. Custom AMIs help create identical servers quickly.

Q: What is Auto Scaling?

A: Auto Scaling automatically increases or decreases EC2 instances based on load. It helps maintain availability and control cost during traffic changes.

Q: What is IAM?

A: IAM is used to manage users, roles, and permissions in AWS. It ensures secure access to AWS resources using policies.

Q: What is an IAM Role?

A: An IAM role provides temporary permissions to AWS services like EC2 or Lambda. It is more secure than using access keys.

Q: What is a VPC?

A: A VPC is a logically isolated virtual network in AWS. It allows us to define IP ranges, subnets, route tables, and security rules.

Q: Difference between public and private subnet?

A: A public subnet has internet access through an Internet Gateway. A private subnet does not have direct internet access and is usually used for databases.

Q: What is a Security Group?

A: A security group acts as a virtual firewall for EC2 instances. It controls inbound and outbound traffic at the instance level.

Q: What is CloudWatch?

A: CloudWatch is a monitoring service used to collect metrics and logs. It helps monitor CPU usage, memory, and set alarms.

Q: What is AWS Lambda?

A: Lambda is a serverless compute service that runs code without managing servers. It is triggered by events like S3 uploads or API calls.

Q: What is RDS?

A: RDS is a managed relational database service. It handles backups, patching, and high availability automatically.

Q: Difference between RDS and DynamoDB?

A: RDS is relational and uses SQL, while DynamoDB is NoSQL and serverless. RDS is used for structured data; DynamoDB is used for high-scale applications.

Q: What is a Load Balancer?

A: A load balancer distributes traffic across multiple servers. It improves availability and fault tolerance.

Q: What is CloudFormation?

A: CloudFormation is an Infrastructure as Code service. It allows us to create and manage AWS resources using templates.

Q: What is S3 Versioning?

A: S3 versioning keeps multiple versions of an object. It helps recover data if files are deleted or overwritten.

Q: What is NAT Gateway?

A: A NAT Gateway allows private subnet instances to access the internet securely without exposing them.

Q: What is VPC Peering?

A: VPC peering connects two VPCs privately so they can communicate using private IPs.

Q: What is EBS?

A: EBS is block storage used with EC2 instances. It is commonly used for OS disks and application data.

Q: What is an EBS Snapshot?

A: An EBS snapshot is a backup of an EBS volume stored in S3. It is used for recovery and creating new volumes.